

IT Helpdesk Policy and Troubleshooting Guide

This document provides standard IT helpdesk policies, troubleshooting procedures, security escalation workflows, remote access guidance, password management rules, and ticket escalation practices. The document is intended for internal employees and can also be used for AI-powered IT helpdesk demonstrations, RAG applications, and Agentic AI learning projects. The policies in this document are designed to improve response consistency, reduce downtime, support remote employees, and ensure proper escalation of security-related incidents.

1. Password Reset Policy

Employees who forget their passwords must first attempt to reset the password using the approved self-service password reset portal. The employee must verify identity using multi-factor authentication before the password can be changed. If the account becomes locked after multiple failed login attempts, the user must contact the IT Helpdesk team. The helpdesk executive may request employee identification details such as employee ID, registered email address, or manager approval. Passwords must follow the company password policy: - Minimum 12 characters - At least one uppercase letter - At least one number - At least one special character - Password reuse is not allowed for the previous five passwords

2. VPN Troubleshooting Procedure

Employees working remotely must use the approved VPN client to securely connect to company systems. If the VPN is not connecting, users should follow these steps: 1. Verify that the internet connection is stable. 2. Restart the VPN client application. 3. Confirm that MFA approval has been completed. 4. Ensure the correct VPN profile is selected. 5. Restart the laptop if the issue continues. Employees using public Wi-Fi should avoid accessing sensitive systems unless the VPN connection is successfully established. If the VPN continues to fail after troubleshooting, the issue should be escalated to the Network Support Team.

3. Outlook Email Support

If Microsoft Outlook fails to open or crashes frequently, users should attempt the following steps: - Open Outlook in Safe Mode - Clear Outlook temporary cache files - Disable unnecessary add-ins - Verify internet connectivity - Recreate the Outlook profile if corruption is suspected. If multiple employees are affected simultaneously, the issue may indicate a broader email server or infrastructure problem and should immediately be escalated to the Email Support Team. Employees should avoid sharing sensitive information through personal email accounts.

4. Laptop Performance and Hardware Support

Employees experiencing slow laptop performance should first restart the device and close unnecessary applications. Startup programs should be reviewed to reduce unnecessary background processes. If the laptop shows repeated overheating, unusual fan noise, battery swelling, hardware warnings, or unexpected shutdowns, the issue must be escalated to the Hardware Support Team. Employees must not attempt to open or repair company-issued devices without approval.

5. Printer and Network Device Troubleshooting

Users facing printer issues should first verify: - The printer is powered on - The printer is connected to the network - Paper and toner levels are sufficient - The correct printer is selected Shared printer failures affecting multiple users should be reported immediately to the Infrastructure Support Team. Employees should avoid reconnecting network devices without authorization.

6. Security Incident Escalation Policy

Any suspected phishing email, malware detection, unauthorized system access, suspicious login attempt, account compromise, or data leakage incident must be treated as a high-priority security event. Employees must immediately: - Disconnect suspicious devices from the network - Avoid clicking suspicious links - Report the incident to IT Security - Inform the reporting manager if business systems are impacted Security-related incidents should never be handled solely through automated systems. Human IT Security escalation is mandatory.

7. Ticket Escalation Workflow

Tickets should be categorized based on urgency and business impact. Low-priority tickets: - Minor software issues - Password resets - Printer troubleshooting Medium-priority tickets: - VPN failures - Outlook access issues - Performance degradation High-priority tickets: - Security breaches - Hardware damage - System outages - Critical business application failure Tickets requiring repeated troubleshooting or unresolved issues beyond two attempts should be escalated to senior support engineers.

8. IT Support Escalation Matrix

Issue Type	Assigned Team	Priority	Escalation Required
VPN Failure	Network Team	Medium	No
Laptop Overheating	Hardware Team	High	Yes
Account Hacked	IT Security	High	Yes
Outlook Crash	Email Support	Medium	No
Printer Failure	Infrastructure Team	Low	No
Data Leakage	IT Security	High	Yes
Slow Laptop	Hardware Team	Medium	No

This document is intended for educational demonstrations and AI helpdesk projects. The procedures and workflows described here are simplified examples commonly used in enterprise IT support environments.